

0.1 New in Version 16 compared to Version 15

- **New indicators and Indices**

- Other Indices Using V-Dem Data
 - * Electoral Integrity Index (v2x_electoral_integrity)
 - * Deliberative Democracy Stock (v2x_delibdem_stock)
 - * Egalitarian Democracy Stock (v2x_egaldem_stock)
 - * Electoral Democracy Stock (v2x_polyarchy_stock)
 - * Liberal Democracy Stock (v2x_lidem_stock)
 - * Participatory Democracy Stock (v2x_partipdem_stock)
- External Variables
 - * Cumulative Fatalities (Best Estimates) in Organized Violence (e_ovctd)
 - * Existence of Organized Violence (e_ovexist)

- **Other new or modified information**

- Changes to the Measurement Model
 - * We have changed the prior distribution for universal thresholds γ_{μ}^k in the V-Dem measurement model from a uniform distribution ($U(-6,6)$) to a normal distribution ($N(0,6)$). We found that the uniform priors were too restrictive and often too uninformative within their bounds to identify unique stationary distributions. After extensive analyses, we found that relatively wide normal distributions provide roughly identical point and uncertainty estimates for latent country-year values as models that use uniform distributions, and tend to converge at a higher rate. Nevertheless, data sparsity still creates difficulties for the identification of a unique stationary distribution for some variables. See Pemstein et al. (2026) for further information about the V-Dem Measurement Model.
- Regimes Survey
 - * The Regimes survey was not updated in v15, but has been updated in v16. Regime variables now have data up to 2025.
- Coder-level Datasets
 - * The coder-level datasets have been re-uploaded, and coder_ids have been changed. Coder_ids remain comparable across coder-level dataset versions.

For more details on changes to previous versions of the dataset, please see Appendix F or the specific version of the codebook. All previous codebook versions are available at <https://www.v-dem.net/data/dataset-archive/>.